



## New iPads coming soon

A new report suggests that Apple will be launching three new iPads this coming spring. Read the story here: <http://dgit.in/iPad17Q3>



## Willow's wireless pump

Willow's smart wireless pump is a new wearable electronic breast pump for moms that fits in the bra <http://dgit.in/WWpump>

your idea is powerful, I believe crowd-funding is your perfect launchpad.”

## The destination

Good to see you here after the months you spent on planning your campaign. Now, all we need to do is put it up on the right platform. At this point you need to look at your project and do a fair bit of investigation. On the surface it might seem to you that the platform you choose doesn't matter as long as your project is good, but that isn't the case. Each platform has its unique characteristics because of which each is suitable for specific types of projects.

There are quite a few factors that you need to take into account, as shown below.

## Funding model

- **All or nothing (AoN)** - In this model, once the campaign is successfully completed, only then the pledged amount is collected. If the pledge goal set is not achieved, no money is collected.
- **Keep it All (KiA)** - In this model, irrespective of the goal being met or not, the amount minus any commissions charged by the platform is handed to the entrepreneur. In case the project fails to complete, it is up to the receiver of the funds to return it to the backers.
- Choose the first if you need a huge amount of money at one go to get started, and chose the latter if you need a continuous stream of money to keep your project alive. Kickstarter follows the AoN approach while Indiegogo allows both.

## Idea type

- **Anything goes** - On these websites, any kind of project can be put up for crowdfunding, as long as it's legal.
- **Creative** - Certain crowdfunding platforms are only for artists and inventors, with the most prominent example being Kickstarter. Wishberry from India is also an artistically inclined platform, and so is FuelADream. The latter, in fact, focuses

more on quality with a maximum of 20 new projects per month.

- **Entrepreneur faced** - Platforms like Microventures and Profounder connect startups with investors from around the world. Faircent is a similar Indian microloans platform.
- **Social causes** - If you're campaign will be raising funds for a social cause, an emergency, or even micro business projects, this type is targeted to that. Platforms in India like Milaap and RangDe are in this category.

## Cost

This varies from site to site. For example, Kickstarter charges 5 percent of funds raised, plus 3 to 5 percent to Amazon Payments which processes the payments. Indiegogo takes 4 percent if the fundraising goal is met and 9 percent if it isn't. There's also a third-party payment processing fee of 2.9 percent. Among Indian platforms, Wishberry charges a ₹3,500 initial fees and a 10% commission if the project completes. Comparatively Catapooolt charges a ₹1,499 Project registration fees followed by at least 10% of the funding raised depending on the plan you choose.

Hence, you need to think about the combined impact of all the above factors to decide the right crowdfunding platform for your project. Any one of these might make or break the chances of your campaign becoming successful in the long run



Indiegogo has an 'anything goes' approach when it comes to allowing projects on its platform

## The legalese

In our country, crowdfunding is fairly nascent. A strong indicator of that is the lack of laws around it compared to the environment beyond India. For example, countries like USA, Europe and Singapore do allow equity based crowdfunding – whereas in India, the regulations are yet to open the sector up, which would allow communities to support the entrepreneurial wave. But in a certain way, the competitive nature and inherent transparency involved in crowdfunding makes it a self-regulated sector. According to Anshulika,

“Even though there aren't any laws and regulations designed specifically for the crowdfunding industry, the competition itself keeps the platforms on their toes to curating the quality and credibility of projects for the funders and at the same time, keeping the payment policies as transparent as possible for the project creators.”

## Roll the dice

You've built the hype, shot the videos, created ripples on social media, and pitched your campaign to countless people before you've finally made it live. Now all you are doing is waiting with bated breath for the crowd to rush in. At this point, one of the most important things you need to be aware of is that in any crowdfunding venture – as with most ideas that rely on popularity these days – there is a certain amount of luck involved. To understand this, have a look at all the me-too projects that have failed over the year due to bad timing. So, if your first Kickstarter or FuelADream project doesn't get the kind of backing and success that you expected, even though you did everything you could, don't give up entirely on the idea itself. Try to rebuild it from scratch - the campaign and maybe even the product, to keep it new and fresh. Keep at it and your very next project might be the next Oculus! 